

A second option for those who *Choose FI* is to use health care sharing ministries (HCSMs) in place of traditional medical insurance. HCSMs are faith-based organizations based on the Christian tradition of helping others in their times of need. HCSMs appeal to many who achieve FI, but who are not interested in early retirement. They provide the simplicity of paying a standard share, similar to an insurance premium, without the complexity of manipulating income to receive subsidies. While more expensive than subsidized insurance, an HCSM is an affordable option with a fixed price for those who opt to continue earning substantial income after achieving FI.

HCSMs are not without their downsides. First, they are not true insurance, so they are not subject to laws governing traditional medical insurance. This allows HCSMs to deny people with preexisting conditions. Therefore, they are not an option for everyone. HCSMs also can cap the number of benefits a person may receive, which traditional insurance can not. This again helps make HCSMs more affordable than traditional medical insurance, but it also creates unique risks in worst-case scenarios.

A third option for medical care builds on geoarbitrage, which we'll discuss in Chapter 7. Many Americans who are otherwise financially